

Gagan Grover

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SUMMARY

Merchandising and Buying professional with over 7 years of experience managing high-volume portfolios (up to £40M annually) across Footwear, Jewelry, and Apparel. Proven ability to curate compelling product assortments, execute complex range planning, and align inventory management with consumer trends to maximize sales & gross margin. Seeking a Merchandising or Buying role to apply cross-category expertise and technical proficiency in fast-paced retail environments. Holds the Right to Work in the UK.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Merchandise Planner

Tesco PLC, UK

August 2024 – Present

- **Category Management:** Manage merchandising for the F&F Brand - Footwear & Accessories category across the UK and Central Europe.
- **Commercial Planning:** Direct WSSI planning for the Footwear category at the subgroup level across 700+ large format stores, overseeing a £40M annual budget.
- **Range Planning:** Execute seasonal range planning by conducting best/worst seller reviews, attribute and size analysis, category buy optimization, sales mix evaluation, and Pareto analysis.
- **Trade Analysis:** Generate and analyze weekly trade reports to identify commercial risks and opportunities, adjusting strategic plans to consistently achieve sales forecasts.
- **Supplier Relations:** Oversee supplier management, including rigorous price negotiation, critical path management, delivery tracking, and comprehensive purchase order administration.
- **Margin Control:** Maximize profitability and maintain gross margins in line with budget parameters by strategically controlling markdown spend.

Merchandising Manager

Collectif London, UK

January 2023 – July 2024

- **Multi-Channel Strategy:** Merchandising across all Channels– Wholesale, Retail & Ecommerce. £6 M Annually.
- **Range Planning & Buying:** Developed seasonal range buying plans for 400+ SKUs based on trend forecasts, historical sales, and multiple product attributes.
- **Inventory Control:** Directed inventory management (OTB, WSSI, markdowns) and analyzed weekly KPIs (sell-through, gross margin, stock turn) to optimize stock cover.
- **Distribution:** Stock allocation across multiple channels – Ecom, Wholesale & Stores based on sell through rate, weeks cover.

Regional Merchandiser

Carat lane India Pvt Ltd, IN

May 2022 - November 2022

- **Revenue Growth:** Drove £9M in annual sales and increased regional revenue by 10% through strategic product allocation and data-driven category optimization.
- **Inventory Management:** Managed 3,000+ active SKUs across 13 stores, consistently exceeding targets for stock turnover, ASP, and ROS.
- **Training:** Upskilled store teams through targeted merchandising training, boosting store conversion by 10% within 3 months.

Assistant Merchandising Manager

Lenskart Solutions Pvt. Ltd, IN

September 2021 - May 2022

- **Assortment Planning:** Planned assortments and seasonal grids for 175+ SKUs across 3 distinct eyewear brands.
- **Data Analytics:** Conducted granular sales analysis across multiple parameters, including brand-wise, city-wise, and attribute-specific performance
- **KPI Optimization:** Drove key business KPIs, focusing on conversion rates, ATV, serviceability, and minimizing reverse orders.

Buyer & Merchandiser

Bata India Ltd, IN

May 2019 - July 2021

- **Retail Merchandising:** Executed merchandising and buying strategies for Casual & Lifestyle Brands across 1,300+ retail stores.
- **Range Building:** Built comprehensive assortments and planned range width to develop highly effective seasonal buy plans.
- **Budgeting & Procurement:** Managed OTB planning and placed orders seamlessly across both import and domestic channels.
- **Lifecycle Management:** Directed merchandise selection, pricing strategies, markdown planning, and marketing alignment for upcoming seasons.

Export Manager

Trident Ltd, IN

August 2014 - October 2015

- **Documentation & Supply Chain Management:** Managed export documentation, commercial invoicing, and international supply chain logistics to ensure on-time global cargo delivery.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Software:** Power BI, Tableau, Fashion Master, Advanced Excel, SAP, ERP
- **Merchandising:** Buying, Forecasting, Replenishment, Allocation, Range Planning, WSSI, OTB Management, Margin Control, Pricing
- **Analysis:** Trend Analysis, Sell-Through Analysis, Weekly Trade Reporting, Competitor Analysis

EDUCATION

M.sc – Footwear: Footwear Design & Development Institute, India • 2019 • Honors: Awarded Silver Medal (82%)

Bachelor of Business Administration: Indraprastha University • Delhi, India • 2014 • Graduated with 76%